

GOSA

Garage Operations & Service Administration

Business & MVP Project Documentation

A digital operating platform for garages, workshops and automotive service businesses.

Core proposition

Organize. Automate. Control. Grow.

The vehicle is the operational anchor. The value is the visibility generated around it.

Executive Summary

GOSA — Garage Operations & Service Administration — is a proposed cloud-based SaaS platform designed to help small and medium-sized automotive businesses digitize, automate and control their daily operations. The platform connects customers, vehicles, repairs, parts, labor, billing, payments and business analytics into one operational workflow.

The central business problem is not simply paperwork. It is **limited operational and financial visibility**. Manual and disconnected processes can make it difficult for owners to know which jobs are active, what work has been completed, what parts were used, which invoices remain unpaid, and where revenue may be leaking.

GOSA therefore aims to move beyond basic garage record keeping. Its long-term differentiator is a **revenue-leakage and operational-visibility layer** that helps owners identify incomplete transactions, unbilled work, stock discrepancies, outstanding payments and other signals that may affect profitability.

The MVP will initially focus on authentication and roles, customer management, vehicle management, repair/job cards, basic billing and a management dashboard with initial leakage indicators. Advanced modules can be added progressively after validation with real garage owners.

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1. Introduction

The automotive repair and service industry depends on efficient management of vehicles, customers, technicians, repairs, parts, payments and daily workshop activity. Many independent garages still rely on paper job cards, notebooks, spreadsheets and informal communication channels. These methods may work at small scale but become increasingly difficult to control as the business grows.

GOSA intends to provide one connected operational system. Every vehicle creates a chain of activity — customer, job, inspection, repair, parts, labor, invoice, payment and future service. GOSA connects that chain so the owner can see what is happening and use the resulting data to make better decisions.

2. Business Opportunity

Current Kenyan garage-software products show that the market already values digital job cards, inventory, invoicing, payments, reporting, role-based access and mobile-ready workflows e.g. Garaji systems, Moti Autocare and Garage soul. A recent 2026 market guide from Mech Connect also identifies the traditional patchwork of notebooks, WhatsApp, spreadsheets and manual stock

records as a major operational problem.

This creates an opportunity for GOSA to focus on a sharper proposition: not simply digitizing records but connecting operational activity to financial visibility and helping owners identify where value may be lost.

3. Problem Statement

Small and medium-sized garages, workshops and automotive service businesses often operate using fragmented manual processes for customer management, vehicle records, job cards, repairs, parts, invoicing, payments and reporting. These disconnected processes can create operational inefficiency, poor accountability, customer-service gaps and revenue leakage.

Core problem: Garage owners lack a connected system that tracks the complete journey of a vehicle from arrival to payment and converts operational data into actionable business intelligence.

- Excessive paperwork and difficult record retrieval.
- Poor visibility into the status of vehicles and repair jobs.
- Parts or labor that may be used but not properly captured on invoices.
- Outstanding payments and weak receivables follow-up.
- Limited ability to measure technician and workshop performance.
- Difficulty identifying trends, bottlenecks and potential revenue leakage.
- Manual processes that become harder to manage as the business grows.

4. Target Market

GOSA will initially target small and medium-sized independent automotive businesses in Kenya, with a long-term opportunity to expand into East Africa and other emerging automotive markets.

- Independent garages.
- Vehicle repair garages.
- Auto service centers.
- Tire and wheel shops.
- Auto electrical workshops.
- Body repair and paint shops.
- Fleet maintenance workshops.
- Car washes.

Primary Customer Persona

Garage owner / manager: typically responsible for business performance, staff, customers, money and operational decisions. The user is likely to rely heavily on a smartphone and may have limited time for complex software.

Desired outcome: “I want to know what is happening in my garage without having to physically check every job.”

5. Proposed Solution

GOSA will provide a centralized digital platform that connects customer records, vehicles, job cards, repairs, technicians, parts, labor, invoices and payments. The platform will progressively add workshop management,

customer self-service and analytics.

Core workflow

Customer → Vehicle → Check-in → Job Card → Inspection/Diagnosis → Approval → Repair → Parts + Labor → Quality Check → Invoice → Payment → Handover → Service History → Follow-up → Analytics

6. Product Architecture

Product 1 — GOSA Core: the foundational product available to all users.

- Customer Management — profiles, contacts, vehicles, history and notes.
- Vehicle Management — registration, make/model, mileage, owner, service and repair history.
- Repair Management — job cards, repair descriptions, status, assignment, priority and notes.

Advanced products / modules

Service & Parts Management

- Services and labor catalogue
- Parts inventory and suppliers
- Stock movements
- Parts issued to jobs
- Low-stock alerts

Workshop Management

- Job queue and workshop board
- Bay management
- Technician assignment
- Inspection and quality control
- Vehicle handover

Payments & Billing

- Quotations
- Invoices
- Receipts
- Partial payments
- Outstanding balances
- Payment history

Customer Self-Service

- Customer portal
- Job status
- Quotation approval
- Invoice and payment status

- Service history
- Feedback

Reports & Analytics

- Operational reports
- Revenue reports
- Technician performance
- Customer retention
- Inventory insights
- Revenue-leakage indicators

Setup & Administration

- Garage Profile
- Branches
- Staff accounts
- Roles and permissions
- Services and pricing
- Payment and notification settings

7. User Roles

Role-based access control should be part of the product architecture from the beginning.

- **Owner / Director:** full business visibility, users, financials, reports and configuration.
- **Garage Manager:** daily operations, jobs, staff, workshop activity and operational reports.
- **Service Advisor / Receptionist:** customers, vehicles, job creation, quotations and customer communication.
- **Technician / Mechanic:** assigned jobs, diagnosis, repair notes, status and parts requests.
- **Parts / Inventory Manager:** stock, suppliers, receiving, issuing and adjustments.
- **Accountant / Finance Officer:** invoices, payments, receivables and financial reports.
- **Customer:** limited self-service access to vehicles, job, quotation, invoice, payment and service history.

8. Application & Website Pages

The public website should explain the problem and convert garage owners into prospects. The authenticated application should be organized around the daily workflow.

Public / Marketing Website

- Home — value proposition and call to action.
- About GOSA — mission, vision and product philosophy.
- Solutions — modules and problems solved.
- Industries — garages, service centers, tire shops, electrical workshops, body shops, fleet workshops and car washes.
- Features — product capabilities.
- Pricing — core and advanced plans.

- Why GOSA — differentiation and value proposition.
- Contact / Demo — lead capture.

Application Pages

- Authentication: login, registration, password reset and onboarding.
- Dashboard: vehicles in workshop, active jobs, approvals, parts, revenue, payments, alerts and leakage indicators.
- Customers: searchable list and detailed customer profile.
- Vehicles: vehicle list and complete service/repair history.
- Jobs: Kanban-style workflow and detailed job card.
- Services & Parts: services, labor, inventory, suppliers and stock movements.
- Workshop: bays, technicians, schedules, inspections and quality control.
- Billing: quotations, invoices, payments, receipts and outstanding balances.
- Customer Portal: job tracking, approvals, invoices, payments and service history.
- Reports & Analytics: executive, revenue, workshop, technician, customer and inventory dashboards.
- Setup: business information, users, roles, permissions, pricing and system settings.

9. Competitive Landscape

GOSA enters an active Kenyan garage-management market. The objective is not to claim that existing systems lack features; rather, the project should identify a specific underserved value proposition and validate it with users.

GARAJI Systems currently markets digital job cards, estimates, invoicing, receipts, customer tracking, M-Pesa, Etims, inventory, role-based operations, multi-location control and analytics.

Mech Connect positions itself around structured workshop workflows, inspections, invoicing, payments, inventory, accounting, CRM and multi-branch operations. Its 2026 guide highlights the importance of connecting job cards, parts and payments.

GARES provides job cards, vehicle history, parts inventory, invoicing, customer management, quotations, technician tracking, financial reports and M-Pesa integration.

These competitors demonstrate that GOSA must differentiate through **business visibility and leakage intelligence**, not simply by reproducing a standard feature list.

Competitive Positioning

Traditional positioning: “Manage your garage digitally.”

GOSA positioning: “Understand your garage digitally — know what is happening, where value may be leaking, and what the data is telling you.”

10. GOSA Competitive Advantage

- 1. Revenue Leakage Intelligence:** connect completed work, parts, labor, invoices and payments so the system can flag suspicious gaps.
- 2. Operational Visibility:** provide the owner with a live view of vehicles, jobs, technicians, payments and bottlenecks.
- 3. Vehicle-Centered Data:** make the vehicle the operational anchor connecting customer, job, parts, labor, invoices, payments and history.

4. Actionable Analytics: move from static reporting to indicators that help owners decide what requires attention.

5. Scalable Architecture: design the platform as a multi-tenant SaaS so a single garage can eventually grow into multiple branches.

11. MVP Scope

The MVP should prove one central hypothesis: **Can a garage manage its daily vehicle and repair workflow digitally and gain enough visibility to reduce operational leakage?**

The first release should not attempt to build every planned module.

- Authentication and role management.
- Garage and staff onboarding.
- Customer management.
- Vehicle management.
- Job cards and repair management.
- Technician assignment.
- Job-status workflow.
- Basic quotations and invoices.
- Payment recording.
- Vehicle service history.
- Owner dashboard.
- Basic reports.
- Audit trail.
- Initial leakage indicators.

Initial Leakage Rules

- Completed job without invoice.
- Invoice without payment.
- Parts issued without a corresponding job.
- Discount above an authorized threshold.
- Completed job with missing labor charge.
- Outstanding invoice.
- Cancelled job with recorded parts usage.

12. Business Model

GOSA should be developed as a SaaS product with modular pricing. Pricing should ultimately be validated through interviews with real garage owners rather than copied directly from competitors.

- Core — essential customer, vehicle and job management.
- Growth — advanced repair, parts, billing, payments and workshop features.
- Professional — analytics, customer self-service, automation and advanced permissions.
- Enterprise — multi-branch, integrations, API access and advanced support.

13. Research & Validation Plan

Before committing to a large build, GOSA should validate its assumptions with actual garage owners, managers, technicians and customers.

- How are customers and vehicles currently recorded?
- How are job cards created and tracked?
- How are parts and labor captured?
- How are invoices and payments handled?
- What causes the most delays?
- Where does the owner believe money is lost?
- What reports are currently available?
- What would the owner want to see every morning?
- What would make the business willing to pay for software?

Validation hypotheses

- Manual processes create significant operational inefficiency.
- Garage owners struggle to identify revenue leakage.
- Owners value real-time visibility into jobs, payments and performance.
- Simple, affordable software is more attractive than complex enterprise software.
- A vehicle-centered system can improve organization and service history.
- Leakage-focused analytics can create value beyond basic garage administration.

14. Security & Scalability

Because GOSA will handle customer, vehicle, operational and financial information, security must be designed into the system rather than added later.

- Secure authentication.
- Role-based permissions.
- Tenant-level data isolation.
- Audit logs.
- Backups and recovery.
- Secure API access.
- Encryption in transit.
- Controlled administrative access.
- Data export and account recovery.
- Multi-tenant SaaS architecture.
- Branch-ready data model.

15. Mission, Vision & KPIs

Mission: To empower automotive businesses with simple digital tools that organize operations, reduce revenue leakage and turn everyday workshop data into better business decisions.

Vision: To become a trusted operating platform for automotive service businesses across Africa.

Core brand message: Organize. Automate. Control. Grow.

Key Performance Indicators

- Registered garages and active garages.
- Monthly active users.
- Vehicles and jobs processed.
- Invoices and payments recorded.
- Average job value.
- Outstanding receivables.
- Repeat customers.
- Average repair turnaround time.
- Parts utilization.
- Revenue per technician.
- **Impact KPI:** value of potential revenue leakage identified and, where measurable, recovered through GOSA.

16. Development Roadmap

Phase 1 — Validation: interview garage owners, map workflows, test the leakage hypothesis and validate willingness to adopt/pay.

Phase 2 — MVP: build authentication, roles, customers, vehicles, jobs, billing, payments, dashboard and initial leakage indicators.

Phase 3 — Operational Expansion: add inventory, suppliers, inspections, workshop scheduling, notifications and deeper reports.

Phase 4 — Customer & Business Intelligence: customer portal, service reminders, advanced analytics, multi-branch management and integration.

Phase 5 — Intelligence Layer: predictive maintenance, demand forecasting, customer intelligence and automated anomaly/leakage detection.

Conclusion

GOSA should not be built simply as another garage management system. Its strongest opportunity is to become an operational visibility platform for automotive businesses.

The first MVP should prove that connecting the vehicle journey — customer, job, repair, parts, labor, invoice and payment — gives owners a clearer view of their businesses and exposes operational gaps that manual processes can hide.

If this hypothesis is validated, GOSA can grow from a simple digital job-management tool into a scalable SaaS platform that helps automotive businesses organize operations, reduce leakage, improve customer service and make data-driven decisions.

GOSA

The vehicle is the starting point. The data creates visibility. Visibility creates accountability. The insight helps the business grow.